

CDN Incident Alert: 0110. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	SK Sanctioned Russian Websites Accessible in Slovakia Avoiding Sanctions And Spread Through Telegram Dissemination	09/03/2026

Summary

- Summary of incident: Sanctioned Russian websites are accessible in Slovakia - all sanctioned domains were available across all three of the largest internet service providers (ISPs) in the country. Hyperlinks to these websites and articles are actively and systematically spread by Telegram accounts into the Slovak information space by channels “Casus Belli Live”, “KSB Správy”, “Pravda víťazí” and “Infokanáľ Klubu nekonvenčne mysliacich”.
- Summary of narrative: Spreading Kremlin propaganda and disinformation targeting the EU, NATO, and Ukraine in order to polarise society, undermine public trust in institutions and weaken support for Ukraine.
- Summary of impact: Systematic information laundering, influx of Russian propaganda and disinformation, and circumvention of EU sanctions frameworks.
- Summary of TTPs: The influence operation aims to divide Slovak Society and facilitate Russian state content by appropriating content from the Russian information space and hiding its origin.
- Summary of recommendations: Engage national regulators to assess ISP compliance with EU sanctions obligations; Flag sanctioned content and Telegram channels through the DSA mechanism.

Incident

Since the beginning of 2022, a network of 8 channels has systematically been sharing content from the Russian embassy in Bratislava and Russian-sanctioned media to divide Slovak [society](#) (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8). Sanctioned Russian state-affiliated websites remained accessible in Slovakia, as internet service providers (ISPs) did not implement blocking measures despite EU [sanctions](#). Telegram-based accounts systematically disseminated hyperlinks and articles from these sanctioned outlets to Slovak-speaking audiences, aiming to amplify Kremlin-aligned narratives critical of the EU, NATO, and support for Ukraine, and to embed these narratives into the domestic information environment.

Narrative

Meta-narrative: The West is morally, politically, and economically degrading;

- **Sub-narrative:** The EU prioritises geopolitical confrontation with Russia over the well-being of its own citizens;
- **Sub-narrative:** NATO’s support for Ukraine prolongs the war and increases insecurity in Europe.

Meta-narrative: Western institutions are deceptive and suppress alternative viewpoints;

- **Sub-narrative:** Mainstream media conceals “truthful” information provided by Russian sources;
- **Sub-narrative:** Sanctions against Russian media represent censorship rather than protective measures.

Impact

Reach:

The channels have published over 741.000 posts, on average receiving around 2000 views per post. Content distributed through Telegram channels and cross-posted into Slovak online communities, generating repeated exposure through shares, reposts, and hyperlink circulation (exact engagement metrics to be determined).

Outcome:

Sustained exposure to sanctioned sources; reinforcement of polarising narratives in the Slovak information space; potential erosion of public trust

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [T0002: Facilitate State Propaganda](#) – The operation seeks to maintain access to sanctioned content

despite EU restrictive measures.

Objective: [T0079: Divide](#) – The operation spreads polarising narratives targeting societal divisions related to EU membership, NATO cooperation, and support for Ukraine.

[T0084.004: Appropriate Content](#) – The pages are republishing content from sanctioned entities.

[T0129.009: Remove Post Origins](#) - At times, the Telegram channels hide the origin of content.

[T0060: Continue to Amplify](#) – Telegram accounts systematically disseminate hyperlinks to sanctioned articles to expand reach within the Slovak information space.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions Taken: Conducted systematic monitoring of sanctioned Russian domains to verify their accessibility across major Slovak ISPs;
Performed data analysis of Telegram channels disseminating hyperlinks to sanctioned websites;

Recommendations:

Engage national regulators to assess ISP compliance with EU sanctions obligations;
Flag sanctioned content and Telegram channels through the DSA mechanism.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	FIMI Assessment
N/A	Russia	See Report	NEST Institute	Telegram	High